Mini-Case Pack — Set 2

Six more one-page drill cases (format and rules identical to `05-practice-cases/mini_cases.md`: ~40-minute drill, 90-second sizing warm-up, whiteboard crack, five-minute verbal answer, five-minute grilling, then the boxed sketch). Set 2 leans Canadian and quant-heavier — use it from November onward, after Set 1.

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Mini-Case 7 · Prairie Sky Tours — ten weeks of summer

Warm-up (90 s): how many tourists visit Winnipeg per year? (Sketch: ~0.9M metro population; leisure+VFR+business visitors ≈ 2–2.5M; answer in millions, state your filters.)

Situation. Prairie Sky Tours runs boat and walking tours in Winnipeg (The Forks, Exchange District) — CAD 1.8M revenue, 82% earned in July–September. Owner Dana wants year-round viability: winter revenue is CAD 90k against CAD 240k of winter fixed costs (staff core, boats stored, office). Options on the table: (A) winter festival partnerships (Festival du Voyageur shuttle-and-story packages, est. revenue 160k, margin 45%, cost to launch 40k); (B) corporate events year-round (est. 220k revenue at 38% margin, needs one salesperson at 70k/yr); (C) close November–March completely (saves 150k of the 240k, forfeits the 90k winter revenue and one core guide who won't return seasonally).

Hard data. Operating-season revenue (April–October) = 1.8M − 90k winter = **1.71M**, of which 82% of the annual total lands in July–September; season contribution 1.71M × 41% ≈ **700k**. Winter today: 90k × 35% ≈ 31k contribution against 240k of fixed cost → **winter drag ≈ −209k/yr**.

Task. Which combination fixes winter, and what is the year-one P&L effect?

> ***Solution sketch.*** *Structure: winter drag quantified → option economics per CAD of fixed cost absorbed → portfolio + people effect. A: 160k × 45% = 72k − 40k launch = +32k yr-1, +72k run-rate. B: 220k × 38% = 84k − 70k = +14k yr-1, scaling with book. C: +150k − 31k lost contribution = +119k but kills the platform A and B need. Strong answer:* ***A + B, keep operating*** *(+46k yr 1, ≈ +156k by yr 2 as B's book doubles), explicitly rejecting C because it trades a one-time 119k for the capability that earns 150k+ recurring. Implementation: sign festival MOU by Sept, hire sales in Oct, corporate pipeline KPI ≥ 30 proposals by Jan.*

Mini-Case 8 · Fjellvann Software — the price rise that scares everyone

Warm-up: how many mid-sized logistics firms are there in Germany? (~3.3M firms total; logistics ~2%; mid-sized band ~10–15% → ~7–10k.)

Situation. Fjellvann (Hamburg) sells route-planning SaaS to 640 German Mittelstand logistics firms at €900/month. Costs to serve: €180/customer/month; sales & admin fixed €2.9M/yr. Churn 9%/yr; new logos 70/yr. The board debates a 15% price rise. Sales predicts churn jumps to 15% and new logos fall to 55; the CFO thinks churn rises only to 11% because switching costs are high (average customer has 4 years of data in the system).

Task. Model both scenarios for the next 12 months. Raise the price or not — and what third option is better than both?

> ***Solution sketch.*** *Today: 640 × €720 CM × 12 ≈ €5.53M − 2.9M = €2.63M EBIT-ish. Price rise, sales*

scenario: base shrinks to ~640×0.85+55 ≈ 599; CM €855 → 599 × 855 × 12 ≈ €6.15M − 2.9M ≈ €3.25M. CFO scenario: ~640×0.89+55 ≈ 625 × 855 × 12 ≈ €6.41M − 2.9M ≈ €3.51M. ***Even the pessimistic scenario adds ~€0.6M*** *— raise. Third option (the distinction-winner): segment the rise — grandfather year-1 for accounts under 2 years (the churn-fragile cohort), full rise for 4-year+ data-locked accounts; expected churn ≈ 10–11% with nearly full price capture. Implementation: 90-day notice, value-recap campaign, save-desk with one-year lock offer; KPI: logo churn ≤ 11%, revenue churn ≤ 6%.*

Mini-Case 9 · Théâtre de la Rivière — subscribers are dying, literally

Warm-up: annual theatre tickets sold in a 750k-person metro? (~8–10% attend ≥1×; avg 2.5 visits ≈ 150–190k tickets.)

Situation. A 480-seat Winnipeg-adjacent francophone theatre: 2,100 subscribers (was 3,400 in 2016), average subscriber age 63; single tickets growing +4%/yr but only 38% of house revenue. Revenue CAD 2.4M (subs 41%, singles 25%, grants 28%, bar/other 6%); grants flat. A board member proposes killing the subscription ("nobody subscribes anymore"); the artistic director proposes a Netflix-style membership at $19/month with unlimited previews and 2 mainstage tickets/season.

Task. Keep, kill, or transform the subscription model? Quantify the transformation's break-even.

Solution sketch. *Subs revenue today ≈ 984k from 2,100 → ARPU ≈ CAD 469/yr. Membership at $228/yr replaces it only at ~4,300 members — double today's subscribers: unrealistic as a like-for-like swap. Strong answer:* ***transform, not replace*** *— keep classic subscription for the 60+ core (highest ARPU, near-zero churn cost), add the membership as an* acquisition *product for under-45s, priced so 2 tickets + previews costs ≈ CAD 180 contribution-neutral vs single-ticket behaviour. Break-even on the new tier: fixed launch ~35k / (228 − ~90 variable) ≈* ***≈250 members year 1*** *— plausible. KPIs: members ≥ 250, member→subscriber conversion ≥ 10%/yr, average audience age −2 yrs by 2028. Trap: killing subs burns 984k of committed cash flow for an unproven ~57k.*

Mini-Case 10 · Bergkette Logistik — the €1.2M digitization pot

Warm-up: cost of one hour of truck+driver in Germany? (~€55–75 incl. vehicle, fuel, tolls, wages.)

Situation. Family freight forwarder near Osnabrück: 210 trucks, €48M revenue, 2.1% EBIT margin. €1.2M available for digitization. Options: (A) telematics + route optimization across the fleet — vendor claims 6% fuel/time saving on €14M fuel+wage cost; cost €800k + €120k/yr. (B) Customer portal + automated dispatch — saves 3 dispatcher FTE (€180k/yr), improves on-time from 91% to 95%, cost €500k + 60k/yr. (C) AI demand forecasting pilot — consultant-pitched, benefits "up to €1M", cost €400k, no reference client in freight.

Task. Allocate the €1.2M. Which claims do you discount, and by how much?

Solution sketch. *Haircut vendor claims: A at half-claim (3%) still saves €420k/yr − 120k = €300k net → payback ~2.7 yrs on 800k. B: 180k − 60k = 120k net + retention value of on-time (protects ~€2M of at-risk contracts at, say, 5% churn risk ≈ 100k expected) → ~220k/yr → payback ~2.3 yrs. C fails the evidence screen (no reference, unbounded claim) → pilot at most with gate, not now.* ***A + B = €1.3M — €100k over: phase B's portal module to year 2*** *or negotiate. The judges' lesson: discounting vendor claims out loud is the credibility move; "up to" is not a number.*

Mini-Case 11 · Red River Creamery — the co-op wants out of the milk trap

Warm-up: Canadian retail market for plant-based milk? (~38M people; ~40% households buy; ~$120/yr ≈ $1.5–2B.)

Situation. A Manitoba dairy co-op (410 farmer-members, CAD 310M revenue, 1.9% net margin) sees fluid-milk volumes −2%/yr. Board debates: (A) value-added dairy (premium cheese/skyr line): $12M capex, reachable margin 8%, cannibalizes nothing, but crowded shelf; (B) private-label plant-based production for a national grocer who has offered a 5-year contract, $9M capex, 6% margin on $25M/yr, but members call it "betrayal"; (C) do nothing and distribute better prices.

Task. Recommend a path the members can vote yes on.

Solution sketch. *Economics: A ≈ $12M for maybe $2–3M/yr at 8% on $30M* if *listings land (listing risk high). B ≈ $9M for a contracted $1.5M/yr margin — the only de-risked cash (national grocer bears demand risk). The member problem is framing, not finance:* ***B recast as "member-owned diversification that funds dairy premiums"*** *— plant-based line run as a separate subsidiary, its profits earmarked to the milk price pool; A phased later from B's cash. Vote-winning implementation: member town halls before the vote, farmer-director on the subsidiary board, dividend rule written into bylaws. The trap: arguing taste/ideology instead of who bears demand risk.*

Mini-Case 12 · Klinikum Weserbergland — 78 open nursing positions

Warm-up: how many hospital nurses in Germany? (~1.5–1.7M care workers; hospital nurses ≈ 500k.)

Situation. Regional hospital group (3 sites, 1,900 staff): 78 unfilled nursing roles force 2 closed wards (~€6.2M annual revenue foregone, contribution ~35%) and €2.8M/yr agency-nurse spend (agency premium ≈ 65% over staff cost). HR proposes an international recruiting program: 60 nurses from the Philippines over 2 years, all-in €38k each (recruiting, language to B2, credential recognition, housing support), historic 3-year retention 70%. The works council demands the money go to existing-staff retention instead (proposal: €2,000/yr bonus for all 620 nurses = €1.24M/yr).

Task. What do you tell the CEO — and how do you keep the works council on side?

Solution sketch. *Cost of the gap: 6.2M × 35% ≈ €2.17M lost contribution + agency premium share (≈ €1.1M of the 2.8M) ≈* ***€3.3M/yr****. International program: 60 × 38k = €2.28M one-off ÷ 70% ≈ €54k per retained nurse — closes ~42 of 78 roles by year 2 and displaces agency spend ≈ €1.5M/yr → payback < 2 yrs. Blanket bonus: €1.24M/yr recurring, zero new capacity, retention effect unproven — but the works council's* problem *(existing staff overload) is real: fund* ***targeted*** *retention (shift premiums for gap wards, 15 senior "mentor" roles at +€6k which the international program needs anyway) ≈ €0.4M/yr. Package: international program + targeted retention, co-designed with the works council (mentor roles are their win), agency spend as the visible enemy. KPI: open roles ≤ 30 in 24 months, agency spend −50%, ward reopening Q3.*

After Set 2: write your own — each member authors one mini-case from a real German or Manitoba company using public information; the team cracks them in W20–W25. Authoring is the deepest drill.